Isabella Urbano-Trujillo

Trondheim, Norway • Email • Personal website

Profile

Interdisciplinary researcher interested in studying welfare and social protection using applied microeconomics and causal inference methods. Committed to rigorous, policy-relevant research that bridges disciplinary boundaries across economics, sociology, statistics, and data science.

Education

PhD Candidate, Social Sciences *2026 – 2029*

Norwegian University of Science and Technology — Trondheim, Norway

- Doctoral researcher in the *WelGain* project funded by the Research Council of Norway, which examines the "visibility bias" in welfare policy evaluation. Supervisor: *Prof. Roberto Iacono*.

MSc, Data Science for Public Policy *2023 – 2025*

Hertie School — Berlin, Germany

- Thesis: *Bridging data gaps with machine learning: Food security predictions in Sudan*.
- Full tuition scholarship and DAAD stipend. Graduation commencement speaker.

BSc, Economics *2016 – 2021*

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — Cali, Colombia

- Graduated *Cum Laude*. Thesis: *Educational gaps and private contributions in public schools in Colombia*.
- Scholarship for best GPA, 2019. Graduation commencement speaker.

Research Experience

Junior Researcher *Aug 2025 – Jul 2026*

International Security and Development Center — Berlin, Germany

Pre-doctoral position in experimental economics within the Welfare Research Program:

- Supported the design and implementation of experimental research (mostly RCTs); collected, cleaned, and analyzed household survey and secondary data.
- Applied econometric, causal inference, and machine learning methods for impact evaluation; wrote reports and academic articles.
- Contributed to the impact evaluations: *Building Local Resilience in Syria*; *Resilience and Crisis Response in Earthquake-Affected Areas in Syria and Türkiye*; and *Restoring Food and Nutrition Security in Sudan* — assessing the effects of livelihood, gender, and agricultural interventions on food security, welfare, resilience, and women's empowerment.

Research Assistant *Jan 2024 – Jul 2025*

International Security and Development Center — Berlin, Germany

Working student position where I conducted literature reviews, managed large survey datasets, and performed quantitative and qualitative analysis to support report writing.

Junior Researcher *Nov 2021 – Aug 2023*

CoreWoman — Bogotá, Colombia

- *Finances with a Gender Lens*: evaluated (using a synthetic control method) a financial-inclusion program for women.
- *Transforming the Care Economy through Impact Investing*: documented care-economy enterprises across the Global South to mobilize capital to the sector.
- *Women's Participation in Value Chains in PDET Municipalities*: strengthened gender equity in firms across conflict-affected territories in Colombia.
- *Gender-Smart Investing Capacity Building Facility*: designed a gender-lens investing strategy for the Yunus Social Business Fund.

Data Visualization Consultant *Sep 2022 – Jun 2023*

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — Cali, Colombia

- Built the food-system platform *PlaSa Colombia* for the Alliance of Bioversity International and the International Center for Tropical Agriculture, centralizing public and private data and creating interactive Tableau dashboards.

Research and Data Assistant *Nov 2019 – Jan 2021*

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — Cali, Colombia

- Supported public- and private-sector research projects through data wrangling, quantitative analysis, report writing, and data visualization.
- Contributed to the *Feria de Cali* (2019) and *Petronio Álvarez Festival* (2018) economic impact studies (ISBN 978-958-5137-14-1).

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant *Jan 2025 – Jul 2026*

Hertie School — Berlin, Germany

- Environmental Economics (Spring 2025 and 2026) and Economics I (Fall 2025): led two weekly lab sessions over a 12-week semester; created slides and designed and graded problem sets, tests, and assignments.

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant *Jul 2019 – Dec 2020*

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — Cali, Colombia

- Tutored macroeconomics, microeconomics, and econometrics; taught data-processing workshops in Stata and R; and data-visualization workshops in Tableau.

Conference Presentations

34th Annual IAFFE Conference *Jul 2026*

International Association for Feminist Economics

- *Transit Captives: Gendered Risk of Sexual Harassment and Assault in Public Mobility Spaces – Bogotá as a Case Study* (with Sofía García-Durrer). Panel: Exploring Vulnerabilities & Risk.

Other Education

Summer School on Socioeconomic Opportunity and Inequality *Aug 2026*

Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality (UChicago) and Georgetown Americas Institute

- Selected participant in a multidisciplinary one-week program on inequality dynamics, social mobility, and public policy evaluation; lectures by Steven Durlauf, Orazio Attanasio, Francis Vella, Yoosoon Chang, and Alexander Monge-Naranjo, among others.

Other Professional Experience

Procurement Assistant *Jun 2021 – Nov 2021*

Belcorp — Tocancipá, Colombia

Logistics Intern *Jan 2021 – Jun 2021*

AB InBev — Bogotá, Colombia

Technical Skills & Languages

Programming	Stata, R, Python, and SQL
Tools	LaTeX, GitHub, Tableau, Power BI, Excel, Agentic AI
Methods	Causal inference (e.g. DiD, RDD, SCM, matching), econometrics (e.g. panel data, fixed effects, IV), impact evaluation, geospatial analysis, machine learning
Languages	Spanish (native); English (C1); German (A2)